AEP FROM ZERO • PART 1 • KNOW YOUR CUSTOMER (AEP)

EPISODE 11

Batch vs Streaming vs Edge Segmentation in AEP

Batch vs streaming vs edge segmentation in Adobe Experience Platform (AEP), explained from zero. Kavya chooses an evaluation method for each of Bloom's five Real-Time CDP audiences with one question, will a journey need to react within minutes, and learns why streaming everything is a mistake, including the 2026 change that stops new attribute-only rules from using streaming segmentation. You will use the AEP audience estimate as a quality gate to catch a broken New This Month rule that claims

Previously: five audiences, no rhythm

- Last time: the relaunch five, built as rules
- Open question: how fast must each one update?
- Batch, streaming or edge, chosen per audience
- An old draft: 9,930 new customers of 10,000
- Today: the estimate becomes a quality gate

KEY IDEA

Five audiences exist as living rules. Today Kavya decides how fast each one must update, and meets a draft that calls 99 percent of Bloom new.

How often should an audience update?

- Evaluation method: how often AEP re-checks
- Found in Audience properties, right panel
- Default: Batch, even if you never look
- Not ingestion: how often, not how data arrives
- Old Bloom: the welcome waited up to six days
- A cart goes cold in hours, not days

KEY IDEA

Every audience has an evaluation method: how often the platform re-checks who belongs. It defaults to Batch, and it is a choice made per audience.

Batch, streaming and edge

Method	Rhythm	Use it for
Batch	Once every 24 hours	Groups that change slowly
Streaming	Near real time	A journey must react fast
Edge	On the same page load	On-site personalisation

KEY IDEA

Batch re-checks once every 24 hours, streaming updates in near real time as streamed data arrives, and edge decides on the page the customer is loading.

One question: react within minutes?

Audience	Method	Why
High-Value Loyalists	Batch	Value changes slowly
Cart Abandoners 24h	Streaming	Rescue has hours, not days
Lapsed 90	Batch	Changes once a day at most
New This Month	Streaming	Target: welcome in a minute
Window Shoppers	Batch	Nurture can wait a day

KEY IDEA

Will a journey need to react within minutes? Only Cart Abandoners 24h and New This Month pass. The other three refresh daily and nobody notices.

Why not make everything streaming?

- Streaming is not a better batch
- It uses more of the licence entitlement
- It constrains what a rule may contain
- It buys nothing for slow-moving groups
- Fast only for data that streams in
- Batch, unless someone names the moment

KEY IDEA

Streaming and edge cost more and constrain what a rule may contain, and streaming is only fast for data that streams in. Default to batch.

2026: no Streaming for new attribute-only rules

- New attribute-only rules: Streaming not offered
- Example: lives in Texas, and nothing else
- Older audiences may still show Streaming
- Streaming is the design, not a promise
- Not offered? Rewrite the rule or slow down

KEY IDEA

Adobe no longer offers Streaming for new rules built only on profile attributes. If the builder won't offer Streaming, the platform is telling you something.

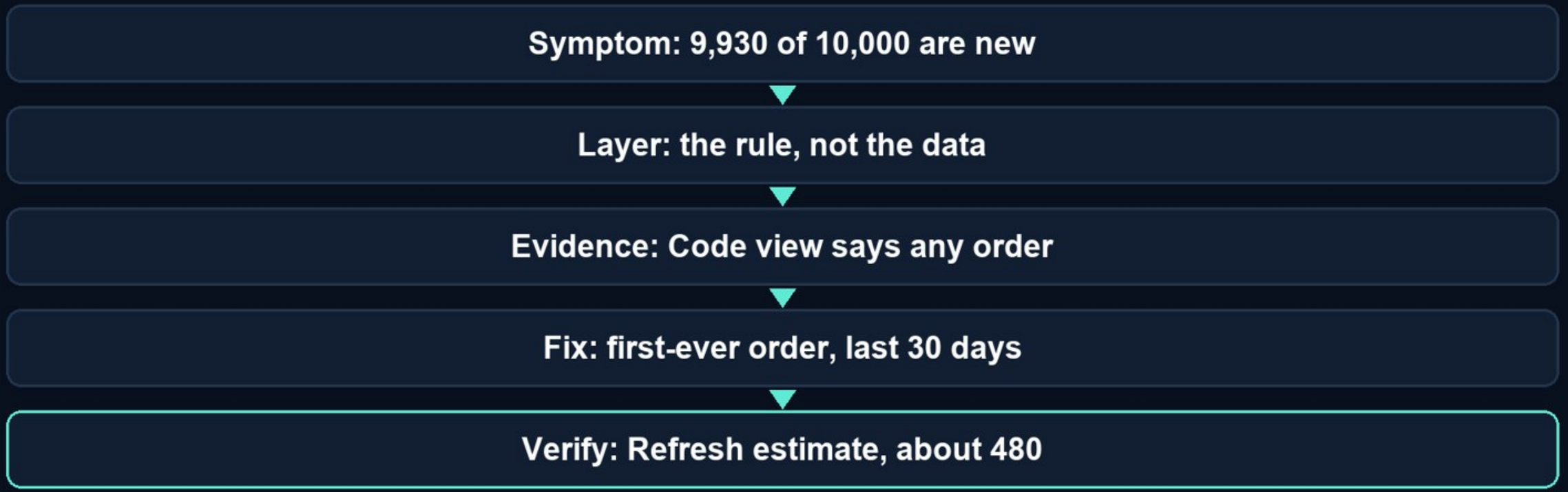
The old draft: 9,930 new customers

New This Month	Old draft	Fixed rule
Rule	Any order, ever	First-ever order, last 30 days
Estimate	9,930 of 10,000	About 480
Who it welcomes	Almost everyone	Genuinely new customers

KEY IDEA

A draft New This Month estimated 9,930 of 10,000. One word, any instead of first, made the audience mean the opposite of its name.

Find the bug: symptom, layer, evidence, fix



KEY IDEA

Kavya used the failure-lab method on the 9,930: the symptom was the estimate, the layer was the rule, and the evidence was in Code view.

Sanity-check an audience before activation

Audience	Estimate of 10,000	Smell test
High-Value Loyalists	1,180	Believable
Cart Abandoners 24h	214	Believable
Lapsed 90	3,890	Believable
New This Month	Draft 9,930; fixed about 480	Draft failed
Window Shoppers	640	Believable

KEY IDEA

Read the estimate, compare it with what you know of the base, and record it, all before anyone activates. Ninety-nine percent is almost never right.

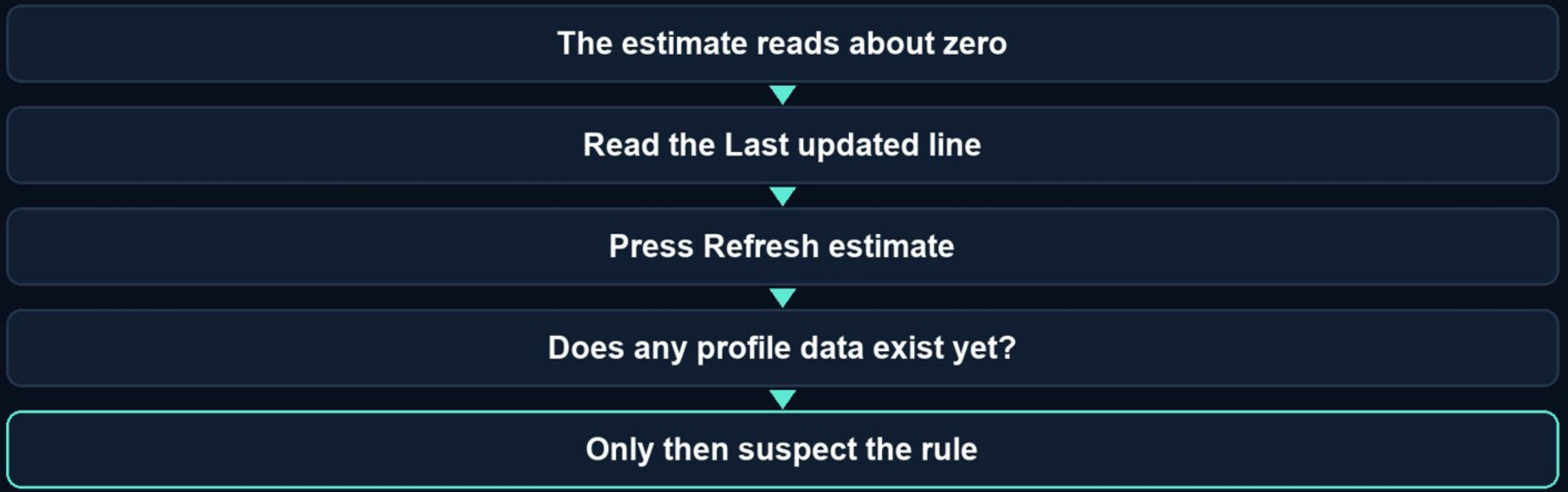
Qualified versus estimated profiles

On screen	What it means
Qualified	Matched at the last evaluation job
Estimated	Approximate, from a sample job
Refresh estimate	Updates the estimate, not Qualified
Last updated	When the estimate was last made

KEY IDEA

Qualified counts who matched at the last evaluation job. Estimated is an approximate figure from a sample job, with its own Refresh estimate and Last updated.

A zero estimate on an empty store



KEY IDEA

An estimate of about zero with Last updated: Not available is expected until profile data exists. It does not prove the rule is wrong.

The overlap trap

- Window Shoppers: 5+ views, zero orders ever
- New This Month: first-ever order, last 30 days
- The boundary: browsed all month, bought today
- Fix: exclude New This Month on purpose
- Write down which journey wins: the welcome

KEY IDEA

Window Shoppers and New This Month can claim the same person unless the exclusion is written into the rule. Check neighbours, not just each audience.

Sixty seconds: the rest of the toolkit

Tool	In one line
Schedule all audiences	Sandbox-wide switch: never touch it
Compose audience	Split, rank, exclude existing audiences
Externally generated	Audiences built outside, brought in
Federated Audience Composition	Query the warehouse, land the audience

KEY IDEA

Four more tools to place, not master: the sandbox-wide Schedule all audiences toggle, composition, externally generated audiences and Federated Audience Composition.

Interview corner

- “Will a journey need to react within minutes?”
- “If yes, streaming. If not, batch.”
- Back it up: two of five, each with a reason
- Add the 9,930 caught by reading one number

KEY IDEA

Will a journey need to react within minutes? If yes, streaming. If not, batch. Then prove you read the estimate before anyone activates.

Recap, your question, and next time

- React within minutes? Streaming. If not, batch
- Estimate first: 99 percent means stop
- Qualified is the last run; Estimated, a sample
- Check neighbours, and exclude on purpose
- Next: Web SDK, datastreams, destinations

KEY IDEA

Choose the rhythm per audience, read the estimate as a gate, and check neighbours. Next: getting audiences out of the platform, safely.